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Host a Website on Amazon S3

GE

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The screenshot shows the Nextwork website landing page. At the top, the text "EVERYONE SHOULD BE IN A JOB THEY LOVE" is displayed in large, bold, white and blue letters. Below this, a row of circular images shows various animals: a koala, a rabbit, a sloth, a giraffe, a cat, a dog, a pig, a sheep, a llama, a pineapple, and a pug. The pug image is highlighted with a yellow background. To the right of the pug image is a dark circle with the text "You?". Below the row of images, the text "Building the best online learning experience to switch careers and upskill. Starting with AWS certifications." is displayed. At the bottom, there is a form with a text input field labeled "Enter your email" and a blue button labeled "Join waitlist". In the bottom right corner, there is a small text box that says "Activate Windows Go to Settings to activate Windows."



Introducing Today's Project!

Project overview

In this project, I will demonstrate how to use Amazon S3 to host a static website. I'm doing this project to learn to learn about AWS cloud services and and how S3 can be used to store object in the cloud.

Tools and concepts

Services I used was amazon S3,Key concepts I learnt include bucket policy, uploading static website files, uploading html,ACLs and bucket URL.

Time, challenges, and wins

This project took me approximately about 50 minutes. The most challenging part was creating bucket and making my website public. It was most rewarding to see that I learnt how to host a website in amazon S3.



How I Set Up an S3 Bucket

What I did in this step

In this step, I will open Amazon S3 and create a storage space for my website files because it is very importance for hosting my website.

How long it took to create the bucket

Creating an S3 bucket took me about 5 minutes

Region selection

The Region I picked for my S3 bucket was Oregon, because it is the region that is close me. The best practice is to choose the region closest to me because it reduces latency and cost.

Understanding bucket name uniqueness

S3 bucket names are globally unique! This means that no AWS account in the entire world can use the bucket's name unless the bucket is deleted. This also means when you create your bucket, you need to make sure the bucket's name is unique too.



Successfully created bucket "nextwork-website-project-ayodele"

nextwork-website-project-ayodele

ObjectsMetadataPropertiesPermissionsMetricsManagementFile systems - newAccess Points

Objects (0)
Objects are the fundamental entities stored in Amazon S3. You can use [Amazon S3 inventory](#) to get a list of all objects in your bucket. For others to access your objects, you'll need to explicitly grant them permissions. [Learn more](#)

Find objects by prefixShow versions

Name	Type	Last modified	Size	Storage class
No objects You don't have any objects in this bucket.				

Upload

Activate Windows



Upload Website Files to S3

What I did in this step

In this step, I will upload my website files into my S3 bucket because no files mean no website. My bucket is still empty, let me get those files so that I can have website to host.

Files I uploaded

I uploaded two files to my S3 bucket - they were index.html file, this determine the structures and WHAT goes inside my website and a folder of images.

How the files work together

Both files are necessary for this project as index.html determines the structure of the website, but the structure alone does not illustrate the content of the website therefore index.html might not have the actual image to display. You need to supply these images separately. That is the reason I have multiple files uploaded.



nextwork-website-project-ayodele [Info](#)

Objects

Metadata

Properties

Permissions

Metrics

Management

File systems - new

Access Points

Objects (2)

Copy S3 URI

Copy URL

Download

Open ↗

Delete

Actions ▾

Create folder

Upload

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Find objects by prefix

Show versions

< 1 > ⚙

☐	Name	Type	Last modified	Size	Storage class
☐	index.html	html	April 22, 2026, 19:46:10 (UTC+01:00)	58.8 KB	Standard
☐	NextWork - Everyone should be in a job they love_files.zip	zip	April 22, 2026, 19:47:56 (UTC+01:00)	846.7 KB	Standard



Static Website Hosting on S3

What I did in this step

In this step, I will make my website available the whole world. This is called hosting and it is important because our website files would stay as files and not as a website without this step, hosting.

Understanding website hosting

Website hosting means a service that rents space on a physical, internet-connected computer (server) to store your website's files—text, images, and code—making your site accessible to visitors worldwide

How I enabled website hosting

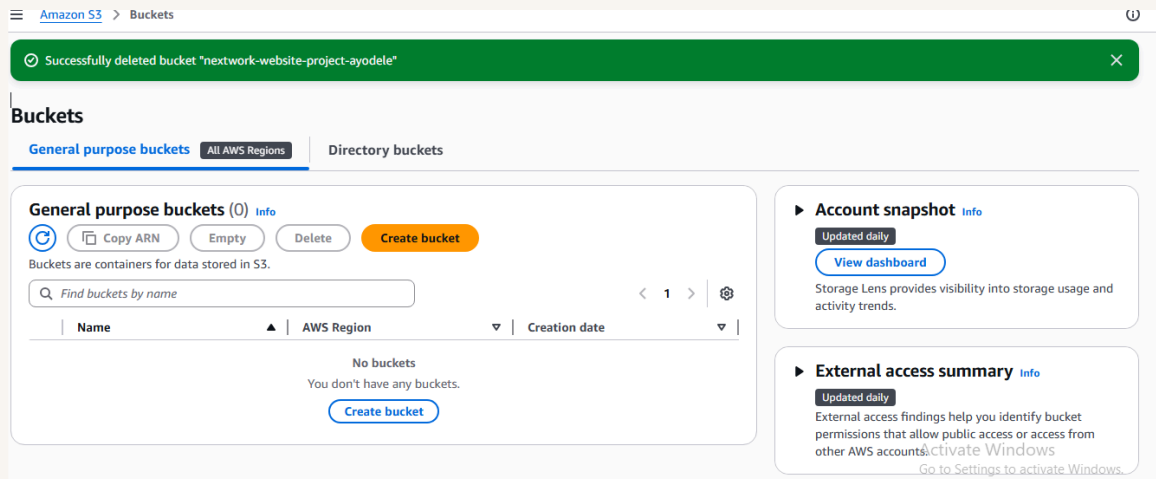
To enable website hosting with my S3 bucket, I navigated to the Properties tab of my bucket in the AWS Management Console. I located the Static website hosting section and selected edit. I selected enable and choose "Host a static website". I specified my Index document (e.g., index.html). I saved changes to generate a unique Bucket website endpoint URL .

Access Control Lists (ACLs)

An ACL is a set of rules that determine who can access a resource. Enabling ACLs in this S3 bucket setup lets you control who can access and do things with the objects (i.e. website files) you upload into your bucket. Yes I enabled it.



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Bucket Endpoints

Understanding bucket endpoint URLs

Once static website is enabled, S3 produces a bucket endpoint URL, which is just like a regular website URL. It lets people visit your S3 bucket's files as a website.

What I saw when I tested the endpoint

When I first visited the bucket endpoint URL, I saw an error message which says 403 forbidden. The reason for this error was because static website is being hosted by S3, but the actual HTML/image files I've uploaded are still private. It's kind of like having a bucket on display, so everyone can see the bucket but the contents are covered up, preventing anyone from seeing what's inside.

403 Forbidden

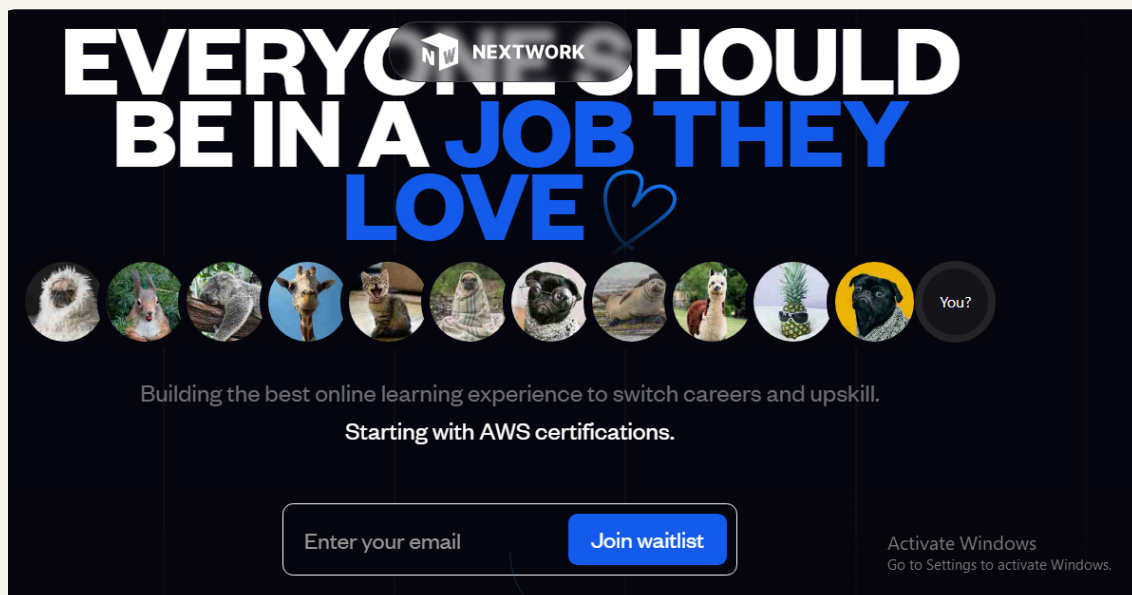
- Code: AccessDenied
- Message: Access Denied
- RequestId: GQ1W45SS2PH0DJBD
- HostId: uz2pkLHf8kGBIIVcnzatbu2Q7nt0B76ph0Q3HNXAxyXQhXdXkRttiscGvyk4Q831s/HXKuQ7lnGnnHwugY4c0lhOH0gH03wT



Success!

How I resolved the 403 error

To resolve this 403 Forbidden error, I updated the access setting of the files in my bucket using ACL. I made my bucket files public.

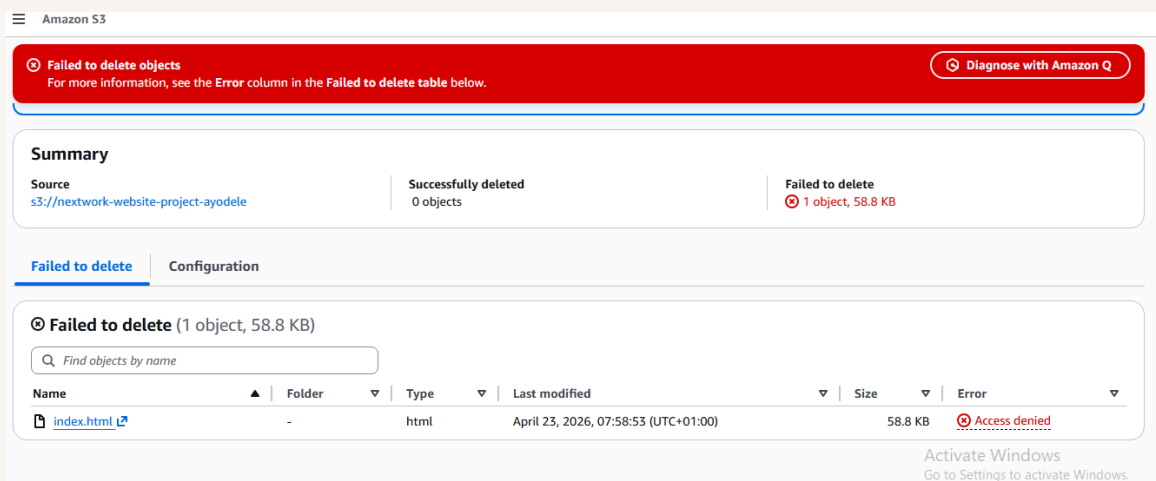




Bucket Policies

What I did in this extension

In this project extension I'm about to create a bucket policy in order to prevent my bucket from being deleted or tampered with. I'm doing this so that no one can upload or deleting objects into my bucket.



What my bucket policy does

My bucket policy prevent deletion of my object. I tested this by trying to delete and saw a message saying I do not have permission to delete.



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